



Britain and France continued to concentrate much of their energy on their imperial connections, there were some surprising success stories, including the Australian airline Qantas, Swissair, and the Scandinavian SAS.

The expansion of the US's international aviation followed the model of "controlled competition" that developed its domestic industry in the 1930s. Pan American lost the monopoly of overseas flights it had enjoyed in the 1930s, and lobbying in Washington determined which airlines got what slice of the action. It was American Overseas Airways that flew the first scheduled transatlantic land-plane service, from Boston to London, in October 1945. But Pan American's chief global rival was TWA, which had developed a flourishing Intercontinental Division during the war. In 1950 the meaning of the abbreviation was appropriately changed from Transcontinental and Western Airlines to Trans World Airlines.

Rivalry between airlines was hooked into a competition between manufacturers Lockheed and Douglas. Although Pan American also began its postwar services with Lockheed Constellations, it was TWA that was identified with the "Connie" from the outset. In 1943, in a calculated publicity coup, Jack Frye and Howard Hughes flew the first Constellation from California to Washington,



ELEGANT CONNIE

A TWA Lockheed 1049 Super Constellation looks its best flying over New York City in the 1950s. TWA was the source of the original request for Lockheed to produce a large pressurized airliner with transcontinental range. The aircraft that Kelly Johnson and the Lockheed team came up with was a design classic, marked out by its extraordinary triple tail. Flying as a passenger in a "Connie" was a comfortable and stylish experience.

D.C., in under seven hours – painted in TWA colors. The airline stuck with the successive Constellation upgrades throughout the 1950s – Super Constellations, then the ultimate Starliner from 1957. Douglas countered with the DC-6 in 1947 and DC-7 from 1953, repeatedly matching and surpassing the Lockheeds' range and speed. The DC-6B and DC-7 were the aircraft that Pan American flew in the 1950s, along with the Boeing 377 Stratocruiser, a propliner intended to match the prewar flying boats for luxury.

